

South Region — H1 FY2026 Commercial Review

Louisiana recovery tracker · the –340 bps story, root cause, and the three-leg plan

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Louisiana Crunchwell share	6.4% → 3.0% (–340 bps, peak-to-trough)
Primary driver	Walmart Sept 2025 reset (~55%)
Endcap deficit (Walmart LA)	23 of 41 Supercenters: 3 Larksfield, 0 Acme
Recovery leg 3	LA retail media at 2.2× portfolio ROI
Leading-indicator watch	Birmingham 5.7→5.4 · Memphis 5.4→5.1
Q2 FY26 signal	LA Crunchwell 3.97→4.16 (value share, early stabilization)

Executive summary

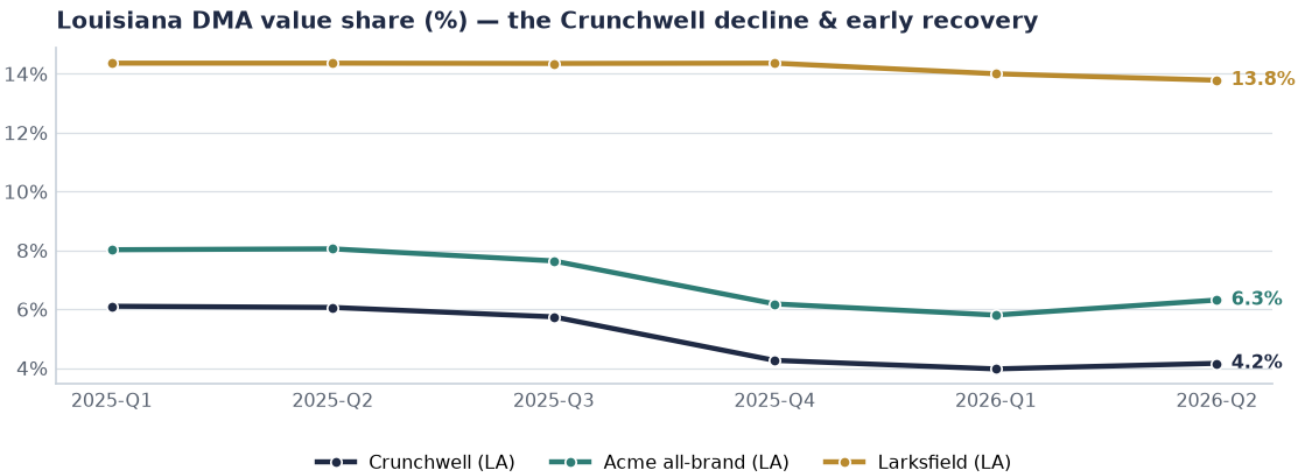
Louisiana is the South Region's defining story and the single largest regional drag on Acme's enterprise number. Crunchwell's Louisiana share fell from ~6.4% to 3.0% — a –340 bps peak-to-trough collapse — driven predominantly by a Walmart shelf change rather than a demand shift. The root cause is now attributed across five hypotheses, dominated by the September 2025 Walmart modular reset. A three-leg recovery is funded and in-market: facing recovery, targeted trade, and a Louisiana retail-media injection running at 2.2× the portfolio ROI. Early Q2 signals show stabilization — LA Crunchwell value share ticked from 3.97% (Q1) to 4.16% (Q2 MTD) — but two leading-indicator DMAs, Birmingham and Memphis, are softening as Field & Honey spreads. This review sizes the decline, decomposes it, and tracks the recovery.

- **Size:** –340 bps of Louisiana Crunchwell share (6.4% → 3.0%), the canonical Mass/Grocery peak-to-trough headline; the all-channel value cut is milder (~6.1 → 4.0) but same-direction.
- **Cause:** five hypotheses — Walmart reset ~55%, Larksfield promo ~20%, Hurricane Tonya supply ~12%, Walmart private label ~8%, Hispanic-shopper shift ~5%.
- **Recovery:** three legs — facing recovery, targeted trade, and LA retail media at 2.2× ROI — with Walmart endcap parity as the highest-leverage single action.
- **Watch:** Birmingham (5.7→5.4) and Memphis (5.4→5.1) are the early-warning DMAs for Field & Honey spread beyond Louisiana.

1 · Louisiana — the decline, sized

LA CRUNCHWELL SHARE	DECLINE	PRIMARY DRIVER	Q2 SIGNAL
3.0% from 6.4% peak	–340 bps peak-to-trough	~55% Walmart Sept reset	4.16% value share, stabilizing

The canonical Louisiana headline is a –340 bps fall in Crunchwell share, from ~6.4% at the Q4 FY24 Mass/Grocery peak to 3.0% in Q1 FY26 (per the geographies master and the LA decline analysis). The value-weighted, all-channel syndicated cut is milder — Crunchwell LA value share moved from ~6.1% to a 3.97% Q1 trough — but points the same direction. Both cuts now show early Q2 stabilization as the recovery lands.



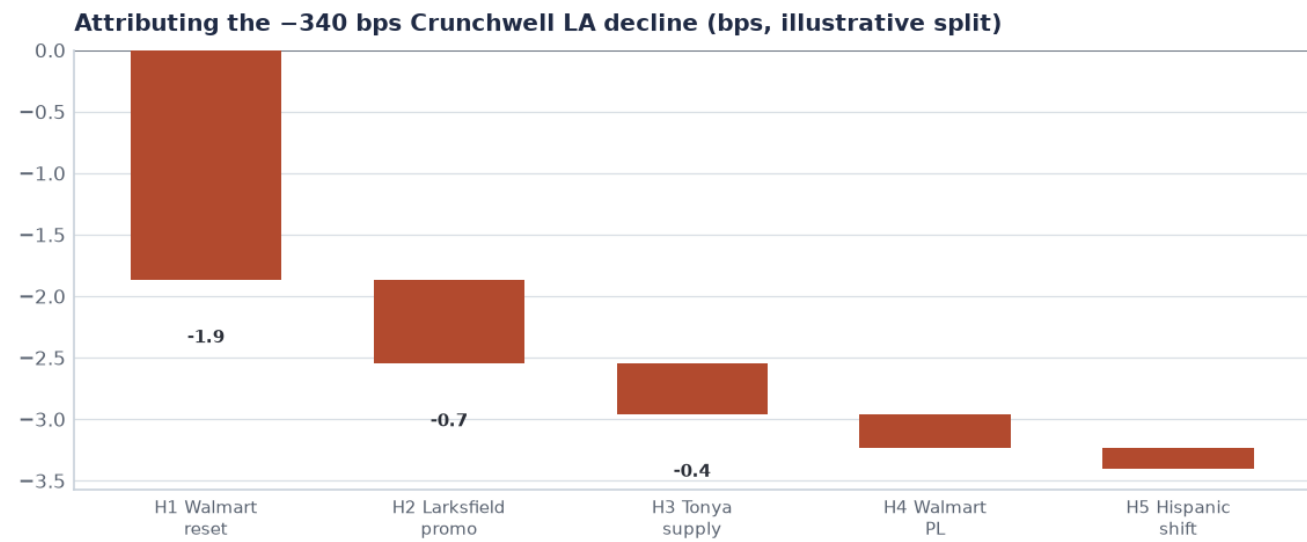
Crunchwell LA value share troughed at 3.97% in Q1 FY26 and ticked up to 4.16% in Q2 MTD while Larksfield held ~14%. Source: syndicated_weekly (LA-DMA, RTE Cereal).

2 · Root-cause decomposition — five hypotheses

The -340 bps decline decomposes across five hypotheses. The dominant driver is the September 2025 Walmart modular reset that cut Crunchwell Mega from 8 to 6 facings and progressively removed Acme endcaps; the remainder is Larksfield promo intensity at Rouses, the Hurricane Tonya supply collapse, Walmart private-label pressure, and a Hispanic-shopper mix shift. The shares below are the working attribution estimates from the LA diagnostic.

Hypothesis	Est. share of decline	Evidence
H1 — Walmart Sept 2025 reset	~55%	Crunchwell Mega 8→6 facings; endcap loss (audit)
H2 — Larksfield promo intensity	~20%	Field & Honey endcaps at Rouses; 21% depth
H3 — Hurricane Tonya supply	~12%	Houston/Thibodaux DC fill dropped to ~52%
H4 — Walmart private label	~8%	Great Value picking up secondary displays
H5 — Hispanic-shopper mix shift	~5%	LA Hispanic pop +9%; Crunchwell under-indexes

Source: LA diagnostic (five-hypothesis attribution); walmart_endcap_audit_la; promo_events_louisiana; shipments (Hurricane Tonya).



The –340 bps decline apportioned to the five hypotheses (bps; shares per the LA diagnostic). Walmart reset dominates. Source: LA diagnostic attribution.

3 · The three-leg recovery

The recovery is scoped, funded, and in-market on three legs. Leg 1 (facings) is the joint Walmart ask carried in the FY27 JBP (Report 35): restore Crunchwell Mega to 8 facings and secure at least one Acme endcap per Louisiana Supercenter. Leg 2 (trade) is a targeted recovery-promo cadence to answer Larksfield's intensity. Leg 3 (retail media) is a Louisiana injection running at 2.2× the portfolio ROI — the most efficient marginal dollar available to the region.

3.1 · Door-level evidence — Walmart, Rouses, H-E-B

Door-level signal (H1 FY26)	Reading	Source
Walmart LA endcaps	23 of 41 Supercenters: 3 Larksfield, 0 Acme	walmart_endcap_audit_la
Rouses on-shelf availability	avg 74% OSA across 15 doors (Crunchwell Mega)	rouses_oos_by_door
Rouses OOS	avg 10 OOS-days in Q1; all 15 doors have Larksfield endcaps	rouses_oos_by_door
H-E-B Cinnamon Twist	delist-risk 0.72 avg; Sept 2026 review	heb_cinnamon_twist_delist_risk

Source: walmart_endcap_audit_la; rouses_oos_by_door; heb_cinnamon_twist_delist_risk.

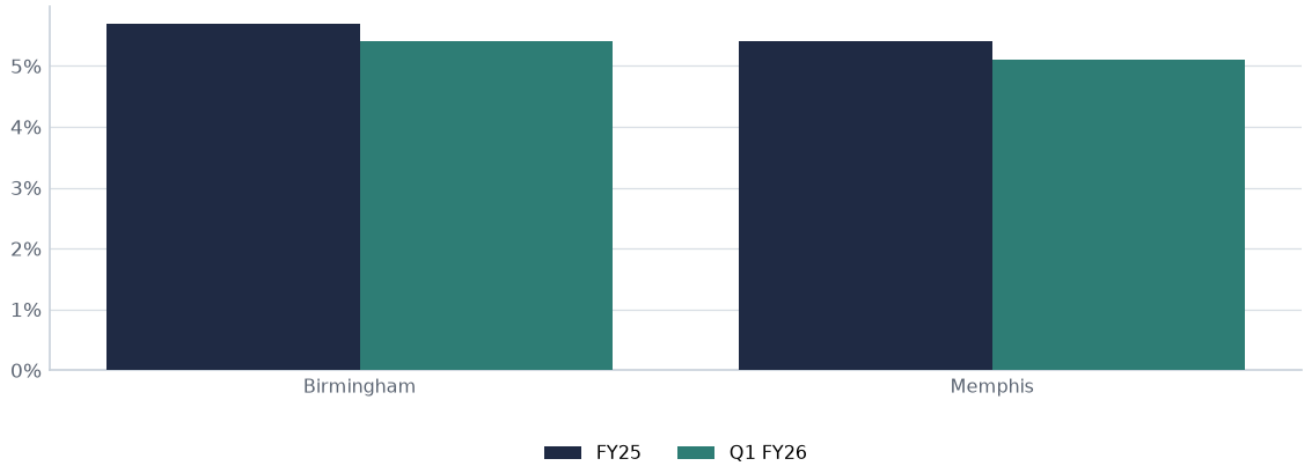
Recovery leg with the highest leverage: the Walmart endcap

Louisiana share is lost fastest at the Walmart endcap (0 Acme vs 3 Larksfield in 23 of 41 Supercenters) and at Rouses shelf (avg ~74% OSA, all doors carrying Larksfield endcaps). Facing recovery at the September 2026 reset is the single action that most moves the recovery. See the Walmart FY27 JBP, Report 35.

4 · Leading-indicator DMA watch & recovery projection

Louisiana is stabilizing, but the same Field & Honey playbook is beginning to appear in two adjacent DMAs. Birmingham Crunchwell share slipped from 5.7% to 5.4% and Memphis from 5.4% to 5.1% (geographies master, FY25 → Q1 FY26) — early spread signals, not yet a decline, but the region's watch-items. Containing Field & Honey in Louisiana is also how the region prevents a second front opening.

Leading-indicator DMAs — Crunchwell share (%), early F&H spread



Both DMAs down ~0.3 points — early-warning, not yet decline. Source: seed_geographies.

Recovery projection (planning estimate): with the three legs landing at the September 2026 reset, the region targets restoring Louisiana Crunchwell share toward the mid-4s through H2 FY26, building on the Q2 uptick to 4.16% value share. This is a plan contingent on facing recovery, not a booked forecast.

Regional risk — the second front

Field & Honey's 14g-protein line extension (12 May 2026) and its early spread into Birmingham/Memphis mean the Louisiana recovery must hold while a protein-and-adjacency threat builds. If the September reset does not restore facings, Louisiana does not recover and the leading-indicator DMAs tip from watch into decline. See Reports 18, 24, 35.

Recommendations & next steps

#	Action	Owner	When
1	Land recovery Leg 1 at the Sept 2026 Walmart reset: Crunchwell Mega 6→8 facings, ≥1 Acme LA endcap.	Marcus Boudreaux	Sept 2026 reset
2	Run the Leg 2 targeted recovery-trade cadence to answer Larksfield promo intensity at Rouses.	Marcus Boudreaux	H1–H2 FY26
3	Sustain the Leg 3 Louisiana retail-media injection at 2.2× ROI through the recovery window.	Tasha Brooks	H2 FY26
4	Stand up active monitoring of Birmingham and Memphis for Field & Honey spread.	Jordan Hsu / Insights	Ongoing